JACOB R. SMITH

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Middle Tennessee State University (Expected May 2027)
Advisor: Daniel J. Smith

M.A. Economics, Middle Tennessee State University (2025)

B.S. Mathematical Economics & Philosophy, *magna cum laude*, Hampden-Sydney College (2023)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Choice Theory, Austrian Economics, Political Economy of Regulation, Historical Political Economy

WORKING PAPERS

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic Capture of the Bottled-in-Bond Act of 1897" (job market paper)

Newly digitized state-by-year Internal Revenue panel (FY1887–1908, 32 states); event-study and difference-in-differences estimates show the Act did not foreclose rectified whiskey — the straight–rectified gap narrowed about 23 percent — but created a certified premium tier whose rents (91 percent of bonded withdrawals) went to incumbent Kentucky and Pennsylvania distillers.

"Private Mechanisms for Stopping Diamond-Dybvig Runs: Evidence from U.S. Newspapers, 1889–1929" (with Daniel J. Smith)

Novel dataset of 544 bank runs from digitized newspapers; codes 40 distinct private mitigation mechanisms, eight not previously documented; 70 percent of runs with a reported response used more than one mechanism.

"Who Killed the Green Fairy? Temperance, Language, and Wine in the Swiss Absinthe Ban of 1908" (with Nicholas A. Jensen)

Canton-level records of the 1906–07 petition and the 1908 vote: organized temperance (Protestant share) predicts petition signatures; holding the French-speaking share fixed, a one-point higher share of national wine revenue goes with a 0.62-point higher yes-share, with no wine effect on six unrelated federal ballots.

"Uncorked: How Wall Street Priced the Repeal of Prohibition" (with Patricia Hummel and Corey Pendleton)

Event study of alcohol and related-industry stocks around newspaper-dated repeal events, 1933 (CAPM, Fama–French, Carhart): alcohol stocks rose when New York voted for repeal delegates, then fell sharply once Alabama, Arkansas, and Tennessee made repeal certain, consistent with investors expecting competition to erode Prohibition-era profits.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Crisis and Local Leviathan"

"Alms and Ale: A Malthusian Test of Welfare Generosity and Alcohol Consumption in OECD Countries, 1995–2023"

OTHER WRITING

"When 'Consumer Protection' Protects Producers from Competition," *The Daily Economy* (AIER), August 11, 2026

ACADEMIC CONFERENCE PAPER PRESENTATIONS

"Bottled in Bondage", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Fort Lauderdale, Florida, November 19–21, 2022

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic use of the Bottled-In-Bond Act of 1897 by both firms and regulators", *Public Choice Society Meetings*. Plano, Texas, March 14–16, 2024

"Distillers and Chemists: Strategic use of the Bottled-In-Bond Act of 1897 by both firms and regulators", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Washington, DC, November 23–25, 2024

"The Father of Food and Drug Law as Strategic Regulator: Dr. Harvey Wiley and the Bottled-In-Bond Act", *Public Choice Society Meetings*. Louisville, Kentucky, March 6–8, 2025

"Panic Before Protection: Bank Runs, Contagion, and Mitigation Measures in the United States, 1889–1929", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Tampa, Florida, November 22–24, 2025

"Alms and Ale: A Malthusian Test of Welfare Generosity and Alcohol Consumption", *Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting*. Tampa, Florida, November 22–24, 2025

COLLOQUIA & WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

Public Choice Outreach Conference, *Center for Study of Public Choice*, GMU (2023)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Public Choice, *American Institute for Economic Research* (2024)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Defending Classical Liberalism, *AIER* (2025)

Summer Seminar on Classical Liberalism and Business, *AIER*, UIC (2025)

Summer Seminar on Classical Liberalism and The Market, *AIER*, UIS (2025)

Summer Seminar on Classical Liberalism, *AIER*, Wabash College (2025)

Economic Freedom Research Colloquium, *Bridwell Institute*, SMU Cox (2025)

Law & Economics w/ PC Insights Workshop, *Stephenson Institute for Classical Liberalism* (2025)

The Untold Stories Behind Financial Crises Workshop, *INET-YSI-University of Lyon 2* (2025)

"Giving an Effective Job Talk" Graduate Papers Workshop, *Institute for Humane Studies* (2026)

Harwood Graduate Colloquium on Governance and Self-Governance: Vincent Ostrom's Framework, *AIER* (2026)

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

American Institute for Economic Research Graduate Fellowship (Summer 2026)

Political Economy Research Institute Ph.D. Summer Fellowship, $5,000 (2024, 2025, 2026)

Economic Freedom Research Colloquium Honorarium, *Bridwell Institute*, $3,000 (2025)

Center for the Study of Political Economy Fellowship (2019–2023)

Pi Mu Epsilon, US Honorary Mathematics Society (2022)

Beta Gamma Sigma, International Business Honor Society (2026)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee, *Virginia Economic Journal* (2026)

Moderator, panel on Tennessee whiskey regulation, MTSU Special Collections (scheduled April 2027)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Middle Tennessee State University

Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2026) — in progress

Principles of Microeconomics (Fall 2025) — instructor evaluation mean 4.40/5

Principles of Macroeconomics (Spring 2026) — instructor evaluation mean 4.02/5

Prepared to teach, with adequate preparation time, any undergraduate course in the curriculum; trained for intermediate microeconomics, econometrics, machine learning for economics, money and banking, public economics and public choice, and economic history.

SERVICE AND LEADERSHIP

H-SC Student Honor Court Investigator, 2022–2023

H-SC *Journal of the Sciences* Editor, Vol. XVII

Alpha Chi Sigma Beta Chi Chapter Vice Master Alchemist (2022) and Historian (2023)

Atkinson Museum Student Museum Board Member, 2022–2023

Union Philanthropic Literary Society Junior Member, 2021–2023

Undergraduate Philosophical Association of Virginia Member, 2022–2023

Wilson Center's Leadership in the Public Interest Four-Year Program Member, 2019–2023

EXPERIENCE

Defense Logistics Agency – Aviation, Richmond, VA May 2021 – Current

Post-Award Contract Specialist (Trainee)

- Received comprehensive cradle-to-grave government contracting training (FAR/DFARS) with hands-on proficiency in information systems including SAP EBS, WAWF, and federal records management
- Collaborated with Subject Matter Experts (SMEs) and OEM vendors to resolve government contract discrepancies and ensure compliance/technical alignment

Tyger Strategies Consulting Group, Midlothian, VA (Remote) June 2020 – August 2020

Business Analyst Intern

- Performed market research and data analysis for a 501(c)(3) nonprofit consulting group
- Developed and presented actionable marketing and strategic recommendations to clients

REFERENCES

Daniel J. Smith (advisor) — Professor of Economics and Director, Political Economy Research Institute, Middle Tennessee State University · daniel.smith@mtsu.edu

Adam Rennhoff — Professor of Economics and Director of Graduate Programs in Economics, Middle Tennessee State University · adam.rennhoff@mtsu.edu

Ryan M. Yonk — Director of Education and Senior Research Fellow, American Institute for Economic Research · ryan.yonk@aier.org